

VMware **Exit** Strategy

A Practical Migration Guide for Enterprises

Step-by-step plan for moving from VMware vSphere to KVM/libvirt and KubeVirt — with hyper2kvm + hypersdk.

Why Exit Now

The Broadcom acquisition changed everything. The clock is ticking.

Broadcom VMware Changes (2024-2026)

Perpetual licenses eliminated. Subscription-only pricing. Product bundles force payment for unused features. Partner ecosystem disrupted. Support response times increasing. Customers reporting 2-12x cost increases.

2-12x

License cost increase
reported by customers

0

Perpetual licenses
available (eliminated)

60%

Partners dropped
from program

Risk Assessment

Risk	Impact	Timeline
License cost escalation	Critical — budget impact immediate	Already happening
End of support (vSphere 7.x)	Critical — security exposure	2025-2026
Feature removal / bundling changes	High — forced upgrades	Ongoing
Talent drain (VMware admins leaving)	High — operational risk	12-18 months
Compliance audit failures	Critical — regulatory risk	Next audit cycle

Migration Phases

A phased approach minimizes risk and maintains uptime.

1

Assessment (Week 1-2)

Inventory all VMs. Classify by criticality (dev/staging/production). Identify dependencies. Estimate disk sizes. Map network requirements. Run pre-flight checks with hyper2kvm.

2

Pilot Migration (Week 3-4)

Migrate 5-10 non-critical VMs (dev/test). Validate conversion quality. Test boot success. Verify application functionality. Build team confidence and document process.

3

Staging Migration (Week 5-8)

Migrate staging environments. Test with real workloads. Validate performance. Set up monitoring. Create runbooks for common issues. Batch process with YAML automation.

4

Production Migration (Week 9-16)

Migrate production VMs in maintenance windows. Use queue-based batch processing. Verify each VM boots and passes health checks. Maintain VMware as rollback for 30 days.

5

Decommission VMware (Week 17-20)

After 30-day parallel run, decommission vSphere. Cancel VMware licenses. Reclaim hardware. Document lessons learned. Celebrate savings.

Target Architecture

Choose your landing zone based on workload needs.

Option A: KVM + libvirt

Best for: Traditional IT, existing Linux admin teams, simple VM workloads.

- RHEL/Fedora with KVM + libvirt
- Cockpit web UI for management
- virt-manager for desktop admin
- Live migration between hosts
- Lowest complexity, fastest adoption

Option B: KubeVirt on Kubernetes

Best for: Cloud-native teams, mixed VM+container workloads, GitOps.

- VMs as Kubernetes resources
- Same tooling for VMs and containers
- Helm charts, operators, CI/CD
- Multi-cluster, multi-cloud capable
- Path to eventual containerization

Option C: OpenShift Virtualization

Best for: Enterprise Red Hat shops, need vendor support + SLA.

- Red Hat supported KubeVirt
- Integrated with OpenShift platform
- MTV (Migration Toolkit for Virtualization)
- Enterprise support contracts
- Certified, hardened, tested

Option D: Hybrid (Recommended)

Best for: Large estates with mixed requirements.

- Critical VMs on KVM/libvirt (simple, reliable)
- Cloud-native workloads on KubeVirt
- Edge sites on K3s + KubeVirt
- hyper2kvm deploys to both targets
- Migrate once, deploy anywhere

Risk Mitigation

How hyper2kvm eliminates common migration failures.

Risk	Without hyper2kvm	With hyper2kvm
VM won't boot after migration	Common — wrong drivers, broken fstab	Auto-fixed: initramfs rebuild, fstab stabilization
Corrupt disk during conversion	Silent corruption, discovered late	Pre-flight validation catches issues before conversion
Windows blue screen (BSOD)	Missing VirtIO drivers	Auto-inject VirtIO drivers + registry fix
Wrong boot mode (BIOS vs UEFI)	Manual detection required	Auto-detected, libvirt XML configured correctly
Network config breaks	VMware NIC names change	Remove VMware NIC configs, let DHCP handle
SELinux denials after migration	Boot fails or services broken	Auto-trigger relabel on first boot
Snapshot chain corruption	Delta files depend on parent	Flatten to single self-contained image
Manual process errors at scale	Human error on VM #47 of #200	YAML automation, batch queue, per-VM results

"The difference between a migration project and a migration disaster is automation. hyper2kvm eliminates the manual steps where things go wrong."

Next Steps

How to start your VMware exit journey.

Inventory Assessment

We'll connect to your vCenter, discover all VMs, and generate a migration complexity report. No changes made — read-only assessment.

Proof of Concept

Pick 3-5 VMs. We migrate them live using hyper2kvm. You verify they boot and run. Takes 1-2 hours. Zero risk to production.

Migration Plan

Based on PoC results, we build a phased migration plan with timeline, resource requirements, and rollback procedures.

Execute

Batch migration with YAML automation. Queue processing handles hundreds of VMs. Boot verification on every one. Progress tracking throughout.

Start Your VMware Exit Today

The longer you wait, the more you pay. hyper2kvm is open source and ready now.
No license, no approval, no vendor lock-in.

hyper2kvm + hypersdk — Enterprise VM Migration Platform
Apache 2.0 Open Source | github.com/ssahani/hyper2kvm